LISTEN · LEARN · SPEAK

Why Reading Books Is So Good for You

A twelve-year study about book readers, paper or screen, the 98% rule for choosing the right book in English, book idioms – and the secret inside Jack's grandfather's book.



Name: _____

Date: _____

My score: _____ / 100 ⭐

★ How to use this worksheet

1 · Before you listen 🧠
Do the warm-up and learn the key words. Questions with 🧠 can be answered before listening.

2 · While you listen 🎧
Answer the 🎧 questions. The ⏱ times show where to find each part of the video.

3 · After you listen 📖
Try the one-page test, find the secret message – and read one page every day!

0 Warm-up: My reading check

fun · no points

Be honest! Tick everything that is true for you. 😊

- ☐ 📖 I finished a book this year
- ☐ 📱 I read more on screens
- ☐ 📗 I've read a book in English
- ☐ 🛏️ I read before bed
- ☐ 🚌 I read on buses or trains
- ☐ 😴 I often give up after a page

My reading score: _____ / 6

Guess! In a twelve-year study, how much longer did book readers live, on average?

(a) about two months (b) almost two years (c) about ten years

🎧 **Check your guess at ⏱ 2:51**

Jack: "Grandad's old book sat on my shelf for ten years..." 📕



💬 Let's talk

Say your answers out loud – or write them in your notebook.

1. What was the last book you finished?

2. Which book did you love as a child?

3. Do you prefer paper books or screens? Why?

4. Have you ever missed your stop because of a book?

1 Key words

vocabulary · 10 points

Match each word or phrase (1–10) to its meaning (a–j). Write the letter in the box. 🧠 Then check at ⏱️ 13:43 and ⏱️ 14:52

- ☐ **1.** a bookworm
- ☐ **2.** to skim
- ☐ **3.** a page-turner
- ☐ **4.** to get lost in a book
- ☐ **5.** absorbed
- ☐ **6.** a graded reader
- ☐ **7.** a spoiler
- ☐ **8.** to flick through
- ☐ **9.** to get into (a book)
- ☐ **10.** an association

a) a book so exciting that you keep turning the pages
b) to start enjoying a book
c) a person who loves reading and reads a lot
d) a link between two things – but not proof
e) a book written for language learners at a particular level
f) to read very quickly to get the general idea
g) to turn the pages quickly without reading carefully
h) to be so interested in a book that you forget the world around you
i) information that tells you what happens in a story too early
j) giving something all your attention



Pronunciation corner 🔊 **BOOK**-worm · ab-**SORBED** (/əbˈzɔːbd/) · **LI**-bra-ry (three syllables – not "libery"!) · **CHAP**-ter · **NOV**-el. Say it: *"It's a real page-turner – I couldn't put it down!"*

2 First listen: the big idea

listening · 2 points

Watch the whole episode once without stopping. Which sentence is the **main message**? 🎧

- (a) Reading books is a healthy, pleasant habit – and in English, an easy book you enjoy, a little every day, works best.
- (b) You should only read difficult novels, with a dictionary next to you.
- (c) Reading on paper and reading on screens are always exactly the same.



Jack's tip: First listen = the **big picture**. Don't stop the video and don't worry about every word. Second listen = the **details**. That's when you answer the 🎧 questions.

🔮 **Predict before you listen!** (no points) Seven of these words are in the episode. One is **not**. Circle the one you think you **won't** hear – then check while you listen.

car park · detective story · desert · bookmark · sailors · glasses · dinosaur · book club

3 Know it or hear it? quiz + listening 10 points

Circle a, b or c. Questions 🧠 1–5: you can probably answer them **before** you listen. Questions 🎧 6–10: listen to find the answer.



🧠 YOU MIGHT ALREADY KNOW

1. "I _____ this book from the library."

(a) lent
(b) borrowed
(c) gave

🧠 Tricky – think about it!

2. "I've been reading this book _____ two weeks."

(a) since
(b) from
(c) for

🧠 Grammar you know

3. "Have you read the new book _____ Jane Smith?"

(a) of
(b) by
(c) from

🧠 Grammar you know

4. "It's a real page-turner." The book is…

(a) very exciting
(b) long and boring
(c) full of pictures

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

5. "No spoilers!" means…

(a) Don't damage the book!
(b) Don't read it too fast!
(c) Don't tell me what happens!

🧠 Look at Exercise 1

🎉 **How many did you know?**
Now press play and test your ears!

🎧 LISTEN AND FIND OUT

6. How far past her stop did Lucy go?

(a) about ten minutes
(b) about forty minutes
(c) about two hours

🎧 ⏱️ 0:05

7. How old was Jack when his grandfather gave him the book?

(a) fifteen
(b) twelve
(c) twenty-two

🎧 ⏱️ 1:13

8. People who read more than 3.5 hours a week were ___ less likely to die.

(a) 3%
(b) 17%
(c) 23%

🎧 ⏱️ 2:51

9. Paper was clearly better than screens for…

(a) stories and novels
(b) texts you read to learn
(c) short messages

🎧 ⏱️ 5:25

10. What did Jack find in the middle of Grandad's book?

(a) an old photo
(b) a leather bookmark
(c) some money

🎧 ⏱️ 20:30

👓 **Fun fact:** Lucy's dad avoided reading for years – then he found out he just needed reading glasses!

4 True or false? listening 6 points

Listen and circle **T** (true) or **F** (false). The ⏱️ times help you find the answer.

1	Lucy finished her detective story while she waited for the next bus.	T	F	⏱️ 0:05
2	Jack opened his grandfather's book on his fifteenth birthday.	T	F	⏱️ 1:13
3	Everyone in the Yale study was over the age of fifty.	T	F	⏱️ 2:51
4	Reading newspapers showed the same strong link as reading books.	T	F	⏱️ 2:51
5	The study proves that reading books makes you live longer.	T	F	⏱️ 2:51
6	Over the years, the advantage of paper seemed to grow.	T	F	⏱️ 5:25

5 Three reading studies 🔍 listening 6 points



Which study is each sentence about? Write **A**, **B** or **C**. ⏱️ 2:51 · 5:25 · 7:38

A · Books and a long life 📚
2016 · Bavishi, Slade & Levy, Yale University

B · Paper or screen? 📱
2018 · a team led by Pablo Delgado, Spain

C · The 98% rule 🔢
Marcella Hu & Paul Nation, New Zealand

1	It combined 54 studies with more than 170,000 people.	☐
2	More than 3,500 people over fifty were followed for twelve years.	☐
3	Learners read the same story with different amounts of unknown words.	☐
4	Book readers lived almost two years longer than non-readers.	☐
5	One unknown word in every fifty is comfortable for reading on your own.	☐
6	The difference was bigger when people read under time pressure.	☐

6 The 98% rule in numbers new! do the maths 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 7:38 and ⏱️ 19:35 – then do a little maths! Write one number in each gap.

😊 **98% – just right!** One unknown word 🟠 in every _____ words. (1)



That's about one new word every _____ lines. (2)

😓 **95% – hard work!** One unknown word 🟠 in every _____ words. (3)



You stop, check the dictionary – and lose the story.

4. 🔢 A text has 100 words. At 98%, how many words don't you know? _____

5. 🔢 The same 100 words at 95%: how many unknown words? _____

6. 📄 One-page test: more than _____ or six unknown words on one page = probably too hard for now.

7 "It's a real page-turner!" listening 10 points



Jack is in a bookshop, looking for a book to read on holiday. Listen at ⏱ 12:19 and write **one word** in each gap (1–8). Then answer A and B. The breakdown at ⏱ 13:43 can help.

JACK
Hi, sorry, could you help me? I'm looking for something to read on 1 _____, but I'm not sure what to choose.



LUCY
Of course. What kind of books do you usually enjoy?

JACK
To be honest, I haven't read a book in 2 _____. I used to love adventure stories, though.



LUCY
Then you might like this one. It's about two brothers who get lost in the 3 _____. It's a real page-4 _____. I read it in two days.

JACK
That sounds great. Is it hard to get 5 _____? I sometimes give up after the first chapter.



LUCY
Not at all. It grabs you from the very first page. Here, have a 6 _____ through.

JACK
Oh, the first line is really good. Okay, I'm interested. Does it have a happy ending?



LUCY
I'm not going to tell you that. No 7 _____.

JACK
Fair enough. I'll take it. And if I can't put it 8 _____, I'll come back for another one.



LUCY
Deal. And if you don't like it, bring it back and tell me why. I want to know.

A. Lucy read the book in _____.

B. The book is about two _____.

8 Phrases to steal expressions 4 points

Match each phrase from the chat (1–4) to its meaning (a–d). ⏱ 13:43

- ☐ **1.** "I haven't read a book in ages."
- ☐ **2.** "It grabs you from the very first page."
- ☐ **3.** "Fair enough."
- ☐ **4.** "I can't put it down."

a) Okay, that's reasonable – I accept that.
b) I love it so much that I can't stop reading.
c) It's been a very long time since I read a book.
d) The story catches your attention immediately.

🛍️ **Your turn: be the bookseller!** (no points) Recommend a book you love to a friend – out loud, in English!

You might like this one. **It's about…** **It's a real page-turner.** **No spoilers!**

9 Book idioms

idioms · 6 points

Complete each sentence with a word from the box. ⏱️ 14:52 · 16:52



book · bookworm · cover · lines · lost · open

1. 😐 He looks very serious, but he's really funny. Don't judge a book by its _____.
2. 😢 If I'm upset, everyone can see it. I'm an _____ book.
3. 🤔 She said she was fine, but if you read between the _____, she was worried.
4. 📋 My manager follows the rules exactly. She does everything by the _____.
5. 🐛 My sister always has a book in her bag. She's a real _____.
6. 🍝 I got completely _____ in the story and forgot to make dinner!



Jack's tip: A **worm** is a long, thin creature that lives in the ground – so a **bookworm** is like a little creature that lives inside books! 🐛📚 And *"Don't judge a book by its cover"* is about people too – just like my grandad's very ordinary-looking book.

10 Borrow or lend? For or since?

new! word pairs · 6 points

Tick the right word. ⏱️ 17:49



📥 **borrow = take** (from someone) · ⏳ **for** + a period: *for two weeks*

📤 **lend = give** (to someone): *Lend me…* ✓ *Borrow me…* × · 📍 **since** + a start: *since Monday*

1. "Can I _____ your book, please?" 📕

☐ 📥 borrow ☐ 📤 lend

2. "Could you _____ me your book?" 📗

☐ 📥 borrow ☐ 📤 lend

3. "I _____ this novel from the library." 🏛️

☐ 📥 borrowed ☐ 📤 lent

4. "I've been reading it _____ Monday." 📅

☐ ⏳ for ☐ 📍 since

5. "She's been a bookworm _____ she was six." 🐛

☐ ⏳ for ☐ 📍 since

6. "I've had this graded reader _____ two weeks." 📘

☐ ⏳ for ☐ 📍 since

📄 Paper or screen? It depends!

think · no points

Paper helps most with texts you read **to learn**, or **in a hurry**. ⏱️ 5:25



1. 📚 Studying a textbook for an exam	☐ 📄 paper	☐ 📱 screen is fine
2. 🏖️ Reading a novel on holiday	☐ 📄 paper	☐ 📱 screen is fine
3. ⏰ Reading an important article in a hurry	☐ 📄 paper	☐ 📱 screen is fine
4. 💬 A quick message from a friend	☐ 📄 paper	☐ 📱 screen is fine
5. 🔬 Learning new facts from a science text	☐ 📄 paper	☐ 📱 screen is fine
6. 😂 A funny short story before bed	☐ 📄 paper	☐ 📱 screen is fine

11 Say it better

common mistakes · 10 points

These sentences sound unnatural. Write a more natural version (2 points each). ⏱️ 17:49

😐 1. "I am reading this book since two weeks." 😊 _____

😐 2. "I like the history of this book." 😊 _____

😐 3. "This book is very interesting for me." 😊 _____

😐 4. "Did you read the book of Jane Smith?" 😊 _____

😐 5. "I read it in English and I understood nothing." 😊 _____



Lucy's tip: History is about real events in the past. For a book or a film, say **story**: *"I love the story of this book."* And to **follow** a story means to understand what's happening.

📄 Try the one-page test!

read · no points



This mini-page has exactly **100 words**. Read it once and underline every word you don't know. Each unknown word = 1%.

Lucy opened her book as the bus left the city centre. It was a detective story, and she was close to the end. "Just one more page," she thought. The bus stopped and started, again and again. People got on and off, but Lucy didn't notice anything. She was completely absorbed in the story. When she finally looked up, the bus was silent and empty. The driver was standing next to her. "End of the line, madam," he said, smiling. Lucy laughed. She was on the other side of the city, but it didn't matter. She knew who did it!

Words I didn't know: _____ → I know about _____ % of the words.

0–2 unknown: just right! 😊 Keep reading.

3–5: a bit hard 😐 – try a graded reader.

6+: too hard for now 😓 – choose an easier book.

✅ Choosing your next book in English (no points) Tick the ones you'll try!

- ☐ 📄 Do the one-page test first.
- ☐ 🔁 Read a book you know in your own language.
- ☐ ✏️ Underline new words – look up repeats only.
- ☐ 📘 Try a graded reader at your level.
- ☐ 💛 Choose something you **want** to read.
- ☐ 👫 Read with a friend – a tiny book club!

⭐ My mini book review (no points) – about a book you've read, in any language!

Title: _____ **by** _____

It's about... _____

I'd recommend it to... _____

My stars: ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ · **One word:** page-turner · hard to get into · funny · sad · exciting · slow

12 Clue word search + secret message

puzzle · 10 points



Step 1: Complete each clue – the first letter and the number of letters are given (1 point each). **Step 2:** Find the 10 words in the grid. They go → ↓ ↘ or ↗ and never cross each other.

1. A person who loves reading: a **b**_____.
2. Grandad hid a leather **b**_____ in the book.
3. You can borrow books from a **l**_____.
4. Jack often gave up after the first **c**_____.
5. "Don't tell me the end!" No **s**_____s!
6. Grandad's stories: travellers and **s**_____.
7. Two brothers get lost in the **d**_____.
8. The book sat on a **s**_____ for ten years.
9. A long story in a book: a **n**_____.
10. Lucy missed her stop on the **b**___.

B	O	O	K	W	O	R	M	R	E
S	A	D	D	O	N	E	R	P	B
A	A	G	E	E	A	E	D	L	O
A	Y	I	A	S	T	N	D	I	O
S	B	Y	L	P	E	O	U	B	K
H	U	W	A	O	I	R	L	R	M
E	S	H	L	N	R	E	T	A	A
L	C	V	E	R	B	S	E	R	R
F	S	P	O	I	L	E	R	Y	K
A	L	O	N	O	V	E	L	N	E

🤫 **Step 3 – the secret message** (no points) Cross out the 10 words. Then write the letters that are left, row by row, from left to right. It's the note Jack found in his grandfather's book!

_____ _____ _____ __ _____, _____ _____ _____

_____ ___ _____.

13 Grandad's book 📕

listening · 6 points



Listen at ⏱️ 20:30. Put the events in the right order. Write 1–6 in the boxes.

- ☐ 📝 On the first page, there was a note in Grandad's handwriting.
- ☐ 🎁 At fifteen, Jack got an old book of short stories from his grandfather.
- ☐ 🌙 He read the whole book that night – and now he reads a page every day.
- ☐ 📦 Years later, Jack was packing his books to move house.
- ☐ 🔖 In the middle, there was a leather bookmark with his name on it.
- ☐ 📚 He said, "Thanks, Grandad," and put it on a shelf.

Think about it 💭 (no points) Grandad said there was "something special" in the book. What do you think it really was?

14 Your turn

writing · 8 points

2 points for each good sentence.



A. A book I love 📚

Use **page-turner**, **get lost in** or **hard to get into**. *e.g. "I got completely lost in the story – it's a real page-turner."*

B. My reading plan 🗓️

What will you read in English? When and where? *e.g. "I'm going to read ten pages on the bus every morning."*

⏱️ My one-page-a-day week

your 7-day mission

Read at least one page of a book in English every day. Want more? Ten minutes!



Day	Pages I read	One new word I underlined	Done?
1			☐
2			☐
3			☐
4			☐
5			☐
6			☐
7			☐

📖 My book: _____ by _____

✂️ Cut out and keep in your pocket

📚 TALK ABOUT BOOKS
It's a real page-turner.
I couldn't put it down.
It's hard to get into.

🛍️ IN A BOOKSHOP
Could you help me?
Have a flick through.
No spoilers, please!

📥 BORROW / FOR
Can I borrow your book?
Could you lend me…?
I've been reading it for…

🔢 READ SMART
the 98% rule
the one-page test
one page a day

Can you do it now?

I can…	Not yet	Almost	Yes!
explain what the twelve-year study found – and why it's a link, not proof.	😟	🙂	😄
use the one-page test to choose a book at my level.	😟	🙂	😄
use borrow / lend and for / since correctly.	😟	🙂	😄
talk about a book: page-turner, get lost in, hard to get into.	😟	🙂	😄



Share it with us! Tell us in the comments about a book you love – in English! Is it a **page-turner**? Did you **get lost in it**? And have you ever missed your stop because of a book? 🚌📖

Answer key

Count your points and write your score on page 1!

0 · Warm-up & predict

Guess: b – almost two years longer. · Predict: **dinosaur** 🦕 isn't in the episode.

1 · Key words · 2 · The big idea

1 c · 2 f · 3 a · 4 h · 5 j · 6 e · 7 i · 8 g · 9 b · 10 d
Big idea: a (2 points)

3 · Know it or hear it?

1 b · 2 c · 3 b · 4 a · 5 c · 6 b · 7 a · 8 c · 9 b · 10 b

4 · True or false?

1 T · 2 F (he didn't open it for years) · 3 T · 4 F (it was books that made the difference) · 5 F (it shows a link, not proof) · 6 T

5 · Three studies · 6 · The 98% rule

5: 1 B · 2 A · 3 C · 4 A · 5 C · 6 B
6: 1 fifty · 2 four or five · 3 twenty · 4 two · 5 five · 6 five

7 · "It's a real page-turner!"

1 holiday · 2 ages · 3 desert · 4 turner · 5 into · 6 flick · 7 spoilers · 8 down · A two days · B brothers

8 · Phrases to steal

1 c · 2 d · 3 a · 4 b

9 · Book idioms · 10 · Borrow or lend?

9: 1 cover · 2 open · 3 lines · 4 book · 5 bookworm · 6 lost
10: 1 borrow · 2 lend · 3 borrowed · 4 since · 5 since · 6 for

11 · Say it better (2 points each)

1 I've been reading this book for two weeks. · 2 I like the story of this book. · 3 I find this book really interesting. / This book is really interesting. · 4 Have you read Jane Smith's book? / …the book by Jane Smith? · 5 I read it in English, but I didn't understand much. / I couldn't follow it.

12 · Word search (1 point per word)

1 bookworm · 2 bookmark · 3 library · 4 chapter · 5 spoiler · 6 sailors · 7 desert · 8 shelf · 9 novel · 10 bus
Secret: Read one page a day, and you will never be alone.



13 · Grandad's book · 14 · Your turn

1 🎁 the old book · 2 📚 on a shelf · 3 📦 moving house · 4 📝 the note · 5 🔖 the bookmark · 6 🌙 read it all that night
Think about it, e.g.: the reading habit he wanted to give Jack.
Paper or screen? paper: 1, 3, 5 · screen is fine: 2, 4, 6
14: your own answers – 2 points per good sentence.

Your score

90–100 🏆 **A real bookworm!** · 70–89 📖 **A page-turner** · 50–69 🔖 **One page a day** · 0–49 🚌 **End of the line – listen again!**

Enjoyed this worksheet? 🎉
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